

Brand Colour & Accessibility Guide

Contrast-Safe Palettes

Most brand palettes are designed for a logo, then break the moment they hit a button, a form error, or a dark background. Plan for interfaces from the start.

What's inside

- Contrast requirements by use case
- Semantic colour role definitions
- Dark mode palette derivation
- Colour blindness verification
- Tint and shade scale construction

Contrast Rules

- 01 4.5:1 minimum for body text on its background
- 02 3:1 for large text, icons, and interactive borders
- 03 Test the brand colour as both text and background
- 04 Never rely on brand colour alone for state

Semantic Roles

- 01 Define primary, secondary, and accent explicitly
- 02 Assign success, warning, error, and info colours
- 03 Specify surface, border, and muted text values
- 04 Document which role each hex belongs to

Scales

- 01 Build 9-step tint and shade scales per core colour
- 02 Ensure adjacent steps are visually distinguishable
- 03 Reserve extremes for backgrounds and text, not accents
- 04 Keep the scale perceptually even, not mathematically even

Verification

- 01 Simulate deuteranopia, protanopia, and tritanopia
- 02 Check the palette on both light and dark surfaces
- 03 Verify in real components, not swatches
- 04 Document any approved exceptions

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